PROactive PRONUNCIATION

Reductions: XT/ST/ND

Simplifying complex clusters of consonants:

When speakers talk quickly in connected speech, some clusters are sometimes too tricky and time-consuming to produce completely. The result is that English speakers drop a consonant to get through the word easier and quicker.

We tend to drop the last consonant in clusters with “xt," "st," and “nd” when followed by yet another consonant.

Ne**xt** year > nexyear
Bo**xed** wine > boxwine
Te**xt**book > texbook
Ha**nd**shake > hanshake
Hi**nd** legs > hinlegs
Ki**nd** man > kinman
Go fu**nd** me > gofunme
Se**nd** you > senyou

Sa**nd**paper > sanpaper
Po**nd** water > ponwader
Be**nd** the rules > bentherules
Ki**nd**ness > kiness
Sa**nd**wich > sanwich
Pou**nd** cake > pouncake
Pe**st** control > pescontrol
Ea**st** coast > eascoast

La**st** call > lascall
Ju**st** do it > jusdoit
Mu**st** have it > mushaveit
Pa**st** lives > paslives
Lo**st** puppy > lospuppy
Re**st**room > resroom
Be**st**seller > Beseller

Practice Sentences:

See you ne<u>xt</u> year
You mu<u>st</u> have had a lot of fun
I forgot my te<u>xt</u>book
I’ll se<u>nd</u> you the email tonight
You ju<u>st</u> need to do it
I’m not a fan of bo<u>xed</u> wine
He will se<u>nd</u> you a pou<u>nd</u> cake
I don’t want to swim in the po<u>nd</u> water
She’s known to be<u>nd</u> the rules in politics
I fou<u>nd</u> my lo<u>st</u> puppy in the re<u>st</u>room
Let’s get started on ne<u>xt</u> year’s agenda
We have no choice but to call pe<u>st</u> control
That ki<u>nd</u> man is mo<u>st</u> known for his ki<u>nd</u>ness
La<u>st</u> call mu<u>st</u> have pa<u>ssed</u> because it's 4 am!
Ne<u>xt</u> year I’m going to write a be<u>st</u>-selling book!
I love the sa<u>nd</u>wiches they make on the Ea<u>st</u> coast
The box did not la<u>st</u> long once it fell in the po<u>nd</u> water